

record in the database but also returns a new model instance if a model is not found. You can also update an existing model and then create a new model with the help of the Laravel's `updateOrCreate()` method. The `delete()` method helps you to remove the model with an ability to delete an existing model by key and query. It is also possible to soft delete a model by using `Illuminate\Database\Eloquent\SoftDeletes` trait on the model and by adding `deleted_at` column to your \$dates property.

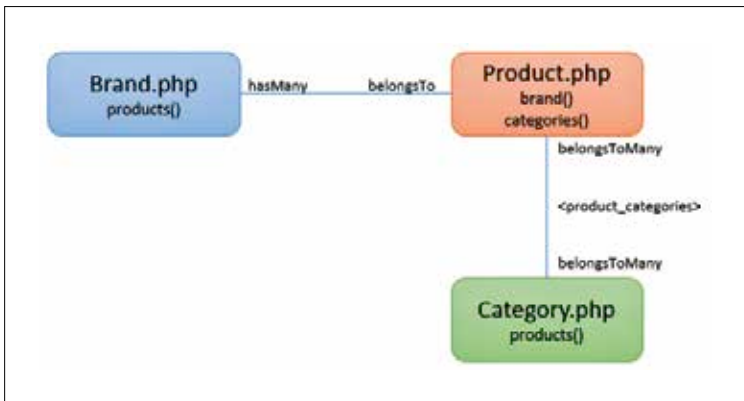
Relationships

In the database world, the concept of Relationships assumes great importance. Eloquent provides support for all types of relationships and hence it is possible to manage and work with them easily. You will have to define relationships as methods, which provides method chaining and querying capabilities as shown below:

```
$user->posts()->where('active', 1)->get();
```

With Eloquent, you can work with One To One, One To Many, One To Many (Inverse), Many To Many, Has Many Through relationships. You should call `Illuminate\Database\Eloquent\Model` before starting to work with relationships.

In One To One, you should call `hasOne()` method and it accepts name of the model as an argument with an optional foreign key. You can define inverse of the relationship using the `belongsTo()` method. You can pass an array to the `withDefault()` method if you would like to populate the default model with attributes. A One To Many relationship is used in a



Working with relationships using Laravel